

Weisheng Zhang

Department of Economics
University of College London
Drayton House 30 Gordon Street
London WC1H 0AN

tel: +44 7788 942432
weisheng.zhang.21@ucl.ac.uk
www.weisheng-zhang.com

Research Fields

Network Econometrics, Panel

Education

University of College London

Ph.D. in Economics

Advisor: Aureo de Paula, Andrei Zeleneev

MRes in Economics

London, UK

May 2027 (exp)

2022

University of Notre Dame

Master in Economics

IN, US

2021

Peking University

Master in Economics

B.S. in Geophysics

Beijing, China

2020

2017

Job Market Paper

“Causal Inference under Dynamic Selection on Unobservables”

2026

Abstract: I study dynamic treatment effects in panel data under staggered adoption when treatment timing depends jointly on unobserved time-invariant heterogeneity and time-varying pretreatment covariates, including lagged outcomes. Untreated potential outcomes follow a nonparametric dynamic panel model that allows flexible interactions between time-varying covariates and latent heterogeneity. I use pretreatment outcome histories to find individuals with similar time-invariant latent factors, and the key requirement is that these histories are sufficiently informative about those latent factors. I develop an identification strategy for the dynamic average treatment effect on the treated (ATT) and propose kernel-based doubly robust estimators for the dynamic ATT. I further combine double cross-fitting with undersmoothing and show that, under suitable regularity conditions, the proposed estimators are root-n consistent, asymptotically normal, and asymptotically unbiased. The simulation study demonstrates that the proposed method provides accurate inference across a wide range of data-generating processes. I illustrate the method with an application to the U.S. family planning programs studied by [Bailey \(2012\)](#) and reestimate their effects on fertility rates.

Working Papers

1. “*Tractable Estimation of Nonlinear Panels with Interactive Fixed Effects*” with Andrei Zeleneev 2025
2. “*Flexible Imputation of Incomplete Network Data*” with Ge Sun 2026

Teaching Experience

ECON0019, Econometrics (UCL, Undergraduate)	2025 - Present
ECON0010, Math for Economists (UCL, Undergraduate)	2024 – 2025
ECON0115, Household Economics (UCL, Undergraduate)	2022 - 2024
Chinese Economy (Peking University, Undergraduate)	2018

Seminar and Conference Presentations (Including Scheduled)

Econometric Society East & Southeast Asia Meeting (2026), Econometric Society Africa Meeting (2026), UCL-CeMMAP Ph.D. Econometrics Research Day (2025), UCL Econometrics Brownbag Seminar.

Scholarship

Center for Microdata Methods and Practice (CeMMAP) PhD scholar, 2022-present

Languages

English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)

References

Prof. Aureo de Paula

Department of Economics
University College London
30 Gordon St
+44 (0) 2076795854
a.paula@ucl.ac.uk

Prof. Andrei Zeleneev

Department of Economics
University College London
30 Gordon St
a.zeleneev@ucl.ac.uk

Prof. Benjamin Deaner

Department of Economics
University College London
30 Gordon St
+44 (0) 7813158453
b.deaner@ucl.ac.uk